

Wenqing Zhang

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Education

Western University

Sep 2025 – Present

- Master of Science in Computer Science
- Supervised by Dr. Umair Rehman
- GPA: 92.5/100

Shandong University

Sep 2021 – Jun 2025

- Bachelor of Engineering in Data Science and Big Data Technology
- GPA: 91/100 (Top 10%)

Research Interests

- AI Misalignment; Technology and User Agency; Dark Patterns

Research Experience

Graduate Researcher, Characterizing LLM Behaviours in Response to Misinformation in Multi-Turn Conversations

Jan 2026 – Present

- Evaluating how frontier LLMs respond to user-provided misinformation across extended conversations
- Proposed a framework in which a simulated user stress-tests the target model through persistent advocacy of a false claim
- Identified distinct model behavioural patterns and found that models are most vulnerable to users who rely on emotional appeals to advocate for a false belief

Graduate Researcher, Impact of AI Chatbots on Human Beliefs

Sep 2025 – Present

- Investigating whether LLMs contribute to a new form of filter bubbles by reinforcing users' existing beliefs
- Drawing on the argumentative theory of reasoning, hypothesized that LLMs can elicit belief revision by evaluating users' reasoning
- Designed an online experiment to compare belief change among participants across prompting strategies

Research Assistant, Evaluating the Integration of AI into Clinical Decision-Making

May 2026 – Present

- Collaborating with Toronto's University Health Network to evaluate the safety of integrating AI for transplant candidacy decisions
- Designing studies to measure physicians' appropriate reliance on AI recommendations

Research Collaborator, Misalignment of Synthetic and Human Respondents

Feb 2026 – Aug 2026

- Compared LLM-generated and human responses to the Big Five personality inventory to assess whether LLMs can substitute for human participants
- Conducted a five-level evaluation: means, distributions, reliability, inter-trait correlations, and behavioural comparison

Undergraduate Researcher, LLM-based Psychological Scale Adaptation

Mar 2024 – Mar 2025

- Developed an LLM-based method that adapts existing scales into test items tailored to diverse respondent populations
- Verified psychological construct alignment, respondent fit, and linguistic diversity of the generated items through automated metrics
- Established reliability and structural validity of the assembled scale through human response data

Publication

Yuchen Han, **Wenqing Zhang**, and Yuqing Sun. (2026). From design to induction: A new paradigm for respondent-centric psychological scale generation. In ICASSP 2026 – IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (pp. 18127–18131). IEEE.

Workshop and Conference Activities

Trainee in Science Communication , Communicating Science Conference Canada	Jun 2026
Poster Presentation , ICASSP 2026	May 2026
Oral Presentation , Western University Computer Science Departmental Conference	Apr 2026

Service and Memberships

Vice President , The Human Factors and Ergonomics Society Student Chapter	May 2026 – Present
Student Member , Rotman Institute of Philosophy	Apr 2026 – Present

Honors and Awards

Best Presentation , Western University Computer Science Departmental Conference	Apr 2026
Silver Medal , Kaggle Credit Risk Prediction Competition (92nd of 3,856 teams)	May 2024
Second-Class Scholarship (Top 15%)	2022 – 2023, 2023 – 2024
First-Class Scholarship (Top 5%)	2021 – 2022